

Gmail SMTP Setup for Alekhya Studio

1. Environment variables

Add these values to .env.local for local development and to Vercel for deployment:

SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com

SMTP_PORT=587

SMTP_USER=your-gmail-address@gmail.com

SMTP_PASS=your-gmail-app-password

CONTACT_TO_EMAIL=saishashiby@gmail.com

2. Use a Gmail App Password

Do not use your normal Gmail password.

You must enable 2-Step Verification on the Google account first.

Then go to Google Account > Security > App passwords and generate a Mail app password.

Use that generated 16-character password as SMTP_PASS.

3. Gmail SMTP settings

Host: smtp.gmail.com

Port: 587

Encryption: STARTTLS / TLS

Username: your full Gmail address

Password: Gmail App Password

4. Deployment notes

In Vercel, open Project Settings > Environment Variables and add the same keys.

After saving the variables, redeploy the project so the contact form can send mail.

5. What happens on the website

The contact form sends submissions to the /api/contact route.

That route uses Gmail SMTP to send the inquiry to saishashiby@gmail.com.

The visitor email is set as Reply-To, so replies go back to the sender.

6. Troubleshooting

If sending fails, first confirm SMTP_USER and SMTP_PASS are correct.

Make sure the Gmail account still has 2-Step Verification enabled.

If needed, generate a fresh App Password and update SMTP_PASS.